ARCHITECT GUIDE TO CAREERS

Achieve your academic and career goals and understand all that you're capable of

16Personalities

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Introduction

Why Academic and Professional Development Matter to Architects

Among the most important goals for Architect personalities is succeeding in their chosen arenas of accomplishment. That can mean different things to individual Architects but almost always includes education and professional endeavors. How well Architects pursue such goals is part of their process of establishing a positive identity within themselves. They seek success not only for its obvious real-world fruits but also to affirm who they are and what they're capable of.

Architects pride themselves on their rationality. Whether they're sitting on a hiring committee or taking Philosophy 101, logical fallacies and emotional reasoning aren't likely to sway them. They have high standards for themselves and others, and before they offer an opinion, they take care to examine an issue deeply with facts and reasoning. Their incisiveness often yields unorthodox solutions that shake up the status quo, leading to friction between themselves and more change-resistant personality types. However, Architects can also be incredibly persuasive, and even if they don't seek out leadership roles, other people often turn to them for advice and guidance.

For Architects, academia and the professional world offer unmatched arenas for self-exploration and growth. There they can find the intellectual challenges that they crave, and they can connect with people who hold similar interests and values. Although self-sufficient Architects can be tempted to go it alone, many find that working with others is the surest way to effect change. They can learn in the classroom and the boardroom to effectively collaborate – often by

brushing up on diplomacy and active listening. As they navigate the worlds of school and work, they often discover companions in their search for a better way.

In the following chapters, we will analyze those areas in greater depth, providing further information as well as suggestions for improvement. Armed with enhanced self-understanding – in addition to insights about other personality types – Architects are poised to overcome and rebalance any tendencies of theirs that don't serve them well. We hope that the following information will guide Architects as they chart their paths toward fulfillment, success, and prosperity.

For a deeper understanding of the traits that make up your personality type and the theory behind them, you can read about our framework here.

Academic Path

Some people spend nearly one-third of their lives studying. Some enter the workforce earlier and don't spend as much time in classes or libraries. Regardless, most people spend at least some of their formative years in school. No matter how long Architects remain in the academic world, time spent there is valuable. Not only can these years set a career path, but the school experience can also affect self-esteem and other matters of psychology well into the future – in both positive and negative ways.

When William Butler Yeats wrote, "Education is not the filling of a pail, but the lighting of a fire," he could've had Architects in mind. They place immense value on the accumulation of knowledge and the rational application of that information, which means they tend not to view education as following a rote experience that leads to a degree or certificate. Instead, they see school as an entry point to a world of possibilities.

It's useful for people with this personality type to explore ways of using their interests and preferences to make the most of their academic experiences. All personality types have weaknesses to deal with, and it's no different for Architects. Fortunately, their insatiable appetite for knowledge and reason gives them a strong foothold in dealing with both their positive and negative tendencies in the world of learning.

How Architects Learn

Architects fulfill themselves by hungrily taking in knowledge, but their need is far from unfocused. They don't learn for learning's sake, but rather because they see their education as the surest path to their goals. However, it's a mistake to characterize Architects' pursuit of knowledge as a matter of practicality alone. They need to challenge themselves as well. Taking the easiest path doesn't satisfy them, and they dislike working only to achieve what's readily achievable. For them, easy mastery leads to boredom – they find the motivation to succeed by testing the limits of possibility.

Balanced Learning Habits

Confidently Independent

Architects admire intellectual skillfulness, and they aspire to explore the key points and fine details of an academic subject with a relish few other types enjoy. When given the opportunity, they can spend hours in solitude forming opinions and pondering ideas, wandering far afield of more conventional classroom material. Their academic approach doesn't always translate to traditional scholarship, which demands collaboration and humility as much as it does raw intelligence and drive. Yet within their own context and on their own terms, Architects can be gifted learners. They take the Isaac Asimov quote, "Self-education is, I firmly believe, the only kind of education there is," more seriously than most.

Architects love to learn independently and, in some ways, to create their own curriculum. If given the space to flourish, they don't disappoint. They're more receptive to mentors and instructors who offer them freedom than to those who enforce a rigid syllabus, and their independent scholasticism makes them proactive students whose learning goes beyond what their teachers provide. The impact of this preference can vary depending on the educational environment Architects find themselves in. Some school systems foster more independence and rejoice when students make subjects their own. Others prefer their students to conform strictly to fixed expectations, which may challenge Architects' preference for adaptation.

Focusing Attention

Even though they're independent and imaginative, Architects don't chase every idea that crosses their paths. Organized and serious, they instead approach a subject of interest with objectives, goals, and results, and they're likely to abandon topics that lack clear direction or purpose. This gives their pursuits a sense of importance, which fosters intense diligence toward their studies.

Although Architects may not advance educationally in ways others would prefer, they're extremely confident in their own direction. Some might view their confidence as commitment, whereas others may regard it as stubbornness and arrogance, but Architects aren't likely to worry much about what either group thinks. For them, dedication comes from within. Their motivations and rewards come from feeling that their studies have integrity and purpose.

Unbalanced Learning Habits

A Lonely Pursuit

Architects thrive on independent, unfettered study – and tear down anything that hinders them from chasing their learning goals. Parents, teachers, and other authority figures who try to derail Architects' efforts to free themselves can run up against these students' total defiance. Much of traditional education expects collaboration – or, at the very least, cooperation. Architects may see their own internal expectations, often in the form of something they "should" do, as more important than cultural and institutional demands. Plainly stated, their conclusion might be, "My way is better."

When Architects don't temper their independence with pragmatism, they can find it challenging to navigate the demanding currents of academia. Even the most enlightened teachers, assistants, and peers may struggle to accept their preferences as a learning style – indeed, many see that as arrogance. Schools and colleges develop standards for a reason. No matter how clever Architect students are, their combination of drive and independence may hinder them in formal education settings, unless they balance those attitudes with more cooperative approaches to learning.

A Narrow Perspective

Architects tend to deepen their knowledge rather than broaden it. This tendency serves them poorly in school; they may be reluctant to accept new insights or information that contradicts what they already know or believe. They have an insatiable need for knowledge, but the voraciousness of their intellectual appetites sometimes lacks an essential ingredient: diversity. Though they thrive on information, their desire for stability can limit how widely they open their minds. What often appears to be arrogance is often an attachment to comfortable ideas, by which they avoid shaking up their predictable intellectual world.

Architects may set up an echo chamber where only their ideas can flourish, while remaining totally unaware of the circumstances they've manufactured. They may accept new information only with great reluctance, no matter how relevant it is. Pondering the depth and breadth of their own knowledge may convince them they're growing intellectually when the real result of that certainty is inertia. Growth is change; when change is discouraged, growth, too, is limited. Although Architects may stabilize their intellectual world by insulating it from outside and disruptive ideas, like a pond without a fresh source of water, they may experience stagnation.

The confidence Architects have in their assertions doesn't necessarily mean they're correct. But those who've seized on an idea can hold it with an all-but-unshakable grip, especially if the idea isn't so much "false" as it is "improper." The arbitrary nature of social conventions can be a sticking point for them. They understand such conventions in an abstract way but see no reason to conform. This casual disregard for social norms can undermine productive relationships, and Architects facing a shaky partnership often react by withdrawing entirely – further narrowing their opportunities to learn and grow.

Rebalancing Learning Habits

Working the System

Architects who succeed in formal education are those who learn how to preserve their self-sufficient spirit while meeting the requirements set

up by whatever program they're in. It's admirable to be independent learners, but if it becomes an obstacle to passing classes or earning degrees, Architects may need to address the negative implications of their independence. Disciplining themselves to comply with others' reasonable expectations is a learning experience. For Architects, it may mean judging what is reasonable, then humbling themselves to appreciate that, in education, independence has its limits.

Introverts can always benefit from becoming more comfortable with teamwork, especially in learning environments. Thinking of parents and teachers as part of a team, rather than authority figures bent on stifling their independence, can help Architects maintain a more stable perspective. Although methods can become obsolete and programs can lose effectiveness, many reflect wisdom gained from experience. There may be a measure of trust needed, and sometimes reluctant Architects must give an established system a chance. As part of their learning process, they can remind themselves that their passion for independent learning is unlikely to disappear, even when it's set aside for a time, that compliance isn't the same as surrender.

Here are some simple guidelines Architects can use when independence is a problem rather than an asset:

- Shift the paradigm. Rather than thinking about authority figures as hindrances, consider how they might be useful as team members who coalesce standards. How can they help the learning process?
- There is power in numbers. No person is an island, so broaden learning resources by including others. It's possible to remain independent while entertaining what others have to offer.
- Expand trust. Some form of fear often lies behind a lack of trust in an institution or a teacher.
- Use your basic confidence to help yourself trust systems or authorities to the degree necessary for success. Should something take you off-course, you have the skills to correct it.
- Find opportunities to discuss any qualms or any independent directions with mentors, teachers, or professors to open communication.

Part of learning is trust. Blind trust always has its limits, but Architects naturally appraise all information and ideas with a critical eye. That won't go away simply because they approach an institution or system with a little more openness, and their critical thinking skills are likely to kick in long before they're led too far astray. A degree of trust can be a lower risk for Architects than they sometimes imagine.

Broadening and Deepening

Architects may disregard the opinions of people they consider less intelligent. However, learning means gaining perspectives different from those they already hold, and openness to others is the key to broadening understanding. Rejecting other perspectives only results in ignorance – but Architect students can find treasures in the least expected places.

Being proven wrong is unpleasant, and Architects often believe that they're right even when they haven't proven anything. When they do test their theories, they do so thoroughly, often justifying their currently held positions – and even supporting positions yet to come. To broaden their learning, they must first open themselves to questioning their pet ideas – and often the best questions come from other people.

When Architects open themselves to new views, they also open themselves up to a greater wealth of knowledge. When they adjust their expectations enough to remain open-minded despite the apparent risks, they ensure a sturdy foundation for their knowledge that makes their opinions and arguments strong. Their sharp wit can carry Architects only so far in life without accurate knowledge to back it up. A willingness to prove verifiable ideas is an excellent way to continually gain knowledge.

Architects can try this experiment to scrutinize their own ideas and beliefs:

- Pick a favorite topic – the stronger your opinion about the topic, the better.
- Using the Internet or any other reference source, find three opposing points of view.

- Within those opposing sources, find a least one valid point that each makes. Rarely are people totally wrong, and there's likely at least one point to appreciate. "Appreciate" doesn't mean embracing the point, rather simply acknowledging that the perspective has some merit.
- Consider what other ideas might deserve the same scrutiny. Remember, the more people test ideas, the more information they have for forming more accurate ideas in the future.

A thorough understanding is valuable, but it's of limited use unless it's also broadened with new information. An understanding that's too narrow in scope may cause more harm than no understanding at all. The adage about a little knowledge being a dangerous thing frequently holds true. Propounding an idea either solidifies its legitimacy or frees Architect students to consider something more meritorious.

Architects in High School

Thanks to their exacting standards and keen intellect, Architects tend to have little difficulty with the academic side of high school. This is especially true if they view high school as a valuable learning experience – or, at least, as an obstacle that they must overcome. Architects prove diligent students in either case. However, those motivated by a wish to escape drudgery are likely to approach high school with less enthusiasm, and they sometimes adopt a cynical view which can steer them away from college after graduation. Conversely, those who believe their high school teachers supported their talents, rather than stifled them, may be more receptive to the idea that higher education has something to offer. Supported Architects see formal education as something that respects their process, making them more willing to trust the system into the future.

Balanced High School Learning

Preferred Courses and Activities

Topics that demand procedural, logical reasoning are more conducive to the Architect personality than those dealing with ambiguity and subjective distinctions. This doesn't mean Architects can't nudge much of what can be found in the humanities into more objective pursuits and,

consequently, find interest and satisfaction there. But such evidence-based treatment is easier in some subjects over others. Demanding proof rarely works with literary criticism in the same way it might for chemistry, for example. This doesn't mean Architects are incapable of handling "softer" courses; they may shine in literature class. Though any course or subject might suit them, some classrooms and curricula can feel like a better fit.

Extracurricular activities are likely to follow the same pattern. Architects are more likely to involve themselves with clubs and organizations that challenge their mental dexterity, like math club, the debate team, or a robotics group. When extracurricular activities aren't compulsory (or Architect students aren't concerned with stuffing their college resumes), they may not take part, preferring instead to develop the skills that interest them independent of any organization. Either way, they're likely to decide based on their own needs and wishes more than on any pressure from parents, teachers, or peers.

In the Social Arena

It's difficult to talk about high school without mentioning the challenge of social experiences. It's a crucial time for adolescents to explore who they are to each other, and friendship and romance are often natural occurrences in the halls of teenage academia.

Just as Architects tend to go deep more than wide with their intellectual considerations, they're also likely to do the same with their social lives. Having a handful of like-minded friends is more important to them than having a large group of diverse but shallow acquaintances. Architects in high school mostly prefer people with whom they can discuss more substantial ideas. Just as they might consider some courses too frivolous, so might they view some potential high school companions. They often have high standards for friendship.

Like most Introverts, teenage Architects show more interest in quieter settings where they can ponder matters on a more profound level, without distractions. School-sponsored sports events and dances may hold an attraction for them only if attendance comes with practical benefits – the opportunity to flirt with specific people also in attendance, for instance. Popularity isn't likely to be among Architects'

goals; they place little value on the number of autographs they obtain in their yearbooks. Quite the contrary, spending time alone or with a few good friends tends to be their preference. In the solitude that many adolescents fear, Architects thrive.

Unbalanced High School Learning

Selective in their Efforts

If taken too far, their selective focus can become problematic. Everyone feels more enthusiastic about some subjects or interests than others, and most students eventually take at least one course that makes them wish they hadn't. Architects have practical reasons to avoid using interest as the sole metric for whether to apply effort, though. If they accept that some courses and some subjects won't interest them, they're likely to take the more holistic approach necessary to pass them in a satisfactory way. If, on the other hand, their priorities demand that every course is interesting or challenging, they may underperform in those that don't measure up.

If their grades depend on rote memorization, Architects usually do well in classes they don't enjoy. They can rattle off names and dates and recite facts by rote, and if they're forced into it, they'll show above-average mastery of grammar and spelling rules. But if they're called on to write an essay on Shakespeare's poetry, the final product may betray their disengagement in the material, even if it remains technically free of errors – there's more to a sonnet than iambic pentameter. Architects have the instincts to become successful students, yet they can hobble themselves by allowing intellectual allure to influence where they invest their energy. They'll usually "get by," but they'll miss out on opportunities to enrich their lives and thinking.

Poor Social Skills

Architects feel out of place in social settings, and high school is, without a doubt, social. Even among other reserved Thinking types, they have difficulty moderating and expressing their own emotions or understanding those of others. Because they also often lack charisma, they can seem cold or aloof, with their reluctance to engage people coming across as arrogance. This can rankle both teachers and peers.

They are not necessarily shy, but Architects who aren't comfortable with their feelings use their wit and mental agility as a substitute for trying to genuinely connect with people. Jokes and sarcasm aimed at authority may be "go-to" coping mechanisms. They sometimes dismiss people who they deem substandard when it comes to argument and rationality – and sometimes they wear their disregard openly. Some Architects have minds more advanced than others; others may assume an attitude of superiority because they can rationally dismiss an academic world that doesn't always make sense. They can all fall into the trap of being "too cool for school," stunting their academic progress at an early stage.

Rebalancing High School Learning

The Renaissance Student

Few people can ever achieve as much as a Renaissance person like Leonardo da Vinci, who expertly applied his hand to every science, technology, cultural trend, and art available during his lifetime. However, modern academia has the advantage of exposing students to a wide variety of subjects and courses. A well-rounded education opens opportunities, and it lends itself to further intellectual development.

Architects who use intuition to tie together ideas are likely to arrive at more significant conclusions with more quantity and variety to connect. Unrelated concepts often blend and emerge as a single creative idea. Architects may want to strive for a balance between narrowing their focus enough to master their preferred topics and having a broad enough vantage point to enrich their lives and overall thinking. Both create a healthy variety of thoughts.

Architect students too selective in applying themselves in high school can benefit from embracing a Renaissance outlook like da Vinci's. Deciding that everything taught in secondary school has potential value is a good first step. As students, Architects can actively decide that all courses are worthy of adequate attention – if for no other reason than exposure to all subjects can broaden their outlook and understanding. The possibility of finding hidden gems of knowledge in unexpected places is a bonus reason for exploring every subject.

Here are some guidelines Architects can follow in their journeys as Renaissance students:

- Choose the unlikely. Treat courses as though they're all experimental. Try a seemingly uninteresting and totally unfamiliar elective. The goal is more than a grade – it's the satisfaction of discovery.
    - Don't know how to sing a note? Take a vocal course.
    - Never played an instrument? Join a band.
    - Never painted in your life? Art!
- Think "broadening" rather than "deepening." Sate your hunger for knowledge by pursuing learning opportunities in new and unfamiliar places.
- Pay attention to the different angles teachers and other students bring to a discussion. Don't shy away from understanding emotional or thematic content more fully. Ask probing questions.
- Remember that high school is a necessary foundation. If it's a requirement to stay there, why not learn something useful?

Striving to become Renaissance students can help Architects round out their high school academic experiences and grow intellectually. Instead of just marking time, they can take advantage of the knowledge high school classes have to offer, for their own empowerment.

Sharing Academic Interests

Poor social skills alone may not inhibit Architects' education, but failure to rebalance their intellectual overconfidence can. One excellent way for them to address both issues is to share their academic interests with someone else. They aren't socially bold, but they can improve their social abilities and humility by offering to help individuals who need it. Tutoring gives Architects a way to expand socially without having to face a group, as well as a chance to share what they know, which they might find surprisingly satisfying.

It's important that Architects measure their success by how well they help those they tutor. Doing the work is one thing, but helping someone else understand the work forces Architects to know the individuals they

help. If they help other students, Architects are likely to also get a taste of genuine gratitude. This might not be something they actively seek, but it's universally enjoyed, and it gives them a reason to continue trying to build interpersonal skills. Architects who excel in their schoolwork can also approach teachers with an offer to tutor someone who could use help in class.

Connecting academically with other students can bring some social benefits through a common interest. Here are steps Architects can try in high school:

- Find out whether the school has an organized peer-tutoring program. Students who are seeking help through such programs are reaching out and are hoping to improve.
- Express a willingness to help. It doesn't have to be a formal situation. If a classmate is showing signs of stress over a difficult unit, it would be magnanimous to offer help.
- Join a study group to create a platform for tutoring without singling out a struggling student.

Most Architects in high school have no interest in popularity or the stereotypical high school social life. There's no inherent problem with that, but connecting with others can still be valuable, and tutoring may be an important way to bring other people into Architects' lives.

Deciding Whether and When to Attend College

Although there are more factors in deciding whether to attend college than just personality types, students' traits can play a role in the equation. Many have long viewed college or university as the quickest path to success and security. However, some of those same people now vigorously argue against higher education for everyone, having seen college dropouts succeed on a grand scale in our technological age. Still others call attention to the research that shows the financial benefits of higher education. Deciding to attend college is an individual undertaking that depends on many factors. There's a niche for everyone, and even though college is one path to finding it, all choices are legitimate. So, what might Architects consider when thinking about their own choices?

Will a degree be necessary for the work I want to pursue?

Professional careers that demand specialized expertise often draw people with the Architect personality type. Sometimes enterprising Architects discover loopholes that allow them to aim for such careers without spending years in academia. But those who want a profession in science, engineering, or the law most commonly see a degree as the most expedient – and sometimes the only – route to their destination.

Other Architects who regard college as too restrictive, not focused on their interests enough, or too slow-paced may find success by striking out on their own. However, there are specific careers where only a degree certifies the experience and knowledge that satisfy hiring specifications.

Will I gain something intangible, yet valuable, from going to college?

For Architects, higher education has value beyond the degree at the end of the academic road. For example, those who are interested in technological fields may have trouble finding resources; the right college can provide computer equipment, lab apparatus, and database access to help them achieve their goals. University professors may also be valuable assets for Architects. Even if they tend to view their instructors as opponents rather than mentors, the friction of classroom debate can be a powerful means of strengthening untested ideas.

It would be remiss to treat college attendance as a purely utilitarian function. Much can be said for the enriching courses and experiences college students pick up along the way, even if they always connect to their future careers and success.

Finally, Architects can use college to defer work for purely financial motives. By using scholarships, loans, or other financial safety nets, they may find that the unfettered time and space that higher education offers can be enough for them to realize their intellectual potential. Often, young students need time to decide what career path they want, and college can provide a buffer between attending high school and earning a living.

Balanced Decision-Making

The Search for Knowledge

Architects with a reasonable perspective understand that no matter how much they know, the amount left to learn is always far greater. A formal education not only satisfies their thirst for knowledge but also provides hands-on learning. When deciding whether and when to attend college, Architects allow their passion for learning to lead them wherever they can gain the most useful experience.

People with this personality type don't just want knowledge; they crave accuracy and precision. They know this involves more than using logic to make their arguments – it also takes a well-grounded sense of reality and the ability to draw on vast stores of personal experience. They don't only want to convince people they're right, they want to *be* right, and for that, there's no substitute for long, dedicated learning. Whether this means pursuing ongoing traditional education, learning on the job, or developing voluntary lifelong learning, Architect students wisely place themselves where they can continuously learn, grow, and feed their intellect with solid facts.

Knowing When to Get an Education

Some Architects who place themselves in a work environment too early run the risk of entering a cycle of rehashing what they already know, instead of learning. However, because of their love of knowledge, they can sense when they're stuck intellectually. In addition, they tend to understand it's never too late to go back to school to gather more knowledge. Architects have little trouble seeing when they're stagnating and need to move in a different direction, and they don't let convention or someone else's timeline determine what they must do from an educational standpoint.

This is just as true for Architects who engage in traditional education but find it limiting. Although it can be damaging in the long run to abandon early efforts toward a degree, alternate opportunities sometimes appear. If job offers or unconventional learning opportunities come along, Architects understand that they're allowed to put college on hold and step into something else. Their independent viewpoint provides them with the flexibility to see and embrace such opportunities.

Unbalanced Decision-Making

Stuck on the Wrong Track

Stubbornness can be an issue for Architects once they settle on a path for their lives either in or out of college. They may decide that pursuing higher education full-time is a logical choice, then follow through on it regardless of contrary evidence. Architects trapped in a rut can be obstinate, insisting that their way is right, even as they suffer the effects of decisions that aren't moving them forward. Limiting themselves to a course of traditional education can stifle this innovative type, but they may remain convinced there's no better way to meet their goals.

On the flipside, some Architects who don't attend college may erroneously rationalize their choice. Their wit and will may allow them to push on while avoiding the truth that they need to learn more. In the worst cases, Architects who decide on an early career track instead of higher education can develop a perverse sense of pride at being "self-made." This satisfies their self-portrayal as independent, and they may resent any implication they lack training – while they remain untrained.

When Some Are Arrogant

Architects often lean on opinion rather than knowledge. It takes little learning for them to seem wise, as their agile minds often make the best use of information and facts. This can cause some to have a drastically inflated sense of their expertise, which may make college seem useless. Overconfidence can be a mistake that poisons a lifetime of potential achievement.

Choosing to bypass college isn't automatically harmful, but doing so out of a false sense of intellectual accomplishment is. Whether enrolled in school or opting for immediate entry into the workforce, Architects who decide they already know enough may cement any lack of knowledge. They may give themselves a false sense they aren't stagnating by drilling down on what they already know and exploring the same intellectual ground – but from different angles. It's once again the difference between deepening and broadening their perspective, and if they feel their cup is already full, it's impossible to add any more to it.

Rebalancing Decision-Making

Back on Track

The greatest rebalancing may come when Architects wake up and discover they aren't happy with their educational choices, be they too involved or too lacking. This can happen earlier or later in their academic or working life, and it may take many rational calculations to realize. It can take an enormous amount of willpower for them to admit that a path isn't working, especially when they've invested significant time and effort chasing the "wrong" decision. For Architects, admitting they've been wrong can be painful.

Developing a philosophy that recognizes every experience as having value can help. There's no substitute for the real-life experience employment can bring, but there's also no substitute for the broader knowledge gained by attending college – even for a short time. Instead of deciding a path is "wrong," a better approach can be to decide that choices were worthy experiments, neither right nor wrong. Architects can decide that it's time to learn the lessons provided by those choices, then move on to potentially greater experiences.

Here are five groups of questions Architects can ask themselves to help them with the waking and discovery process:

- "Do I feel burned out? Is there too much tedium or annoyance associated with what I'm doing now?" (Keep in mind that almost every ongoing situation has periods of tedium and annoyance. However, in this case, it's a matter of degree.)
- "Do I feel like I'm growing? Am I learning new skills or gaining new knowledge and understanding?"
- "Do I connect with what I'm doing? Is there enough intellectual rigor to keep me engaged? Is there a sense of purpose attached to what I'm doing?"
- "Is there a clear vision of where I'm going if I continue with what I'm doing? If so, do I like it? If not, what does the lack of clarity mean, and how does it impact my decision-making?"
- "Are there other, better opportunities waiting for me elsewhere? If so, what's keeping me from pursuing them? If not, have I explored all the possibilities?"

Architects can change their minds and correct their course like anyone else. For them, it may require accepting that their earlier decisions lacked necessary information or insight. The truest mark of intelligence is the ability to consider new information, take it on board, and change perspective. Fortunately, life forgives most missteps, lessons are learnable, and beginning a new direction involves deciding to move forward.

Opening Perspectives

Architects can't decide on the right path without a reasonable picture of what that path is. Part of what might keep them from such discovery is assuming they already have the information they need. Rebalancing an inflated sense of their knowledge can free their minds to absorb broader information. One way to "deflate" is to seek advice or mentorship from those more advanced in their chosen academic or career path, to ask for the insight and wisdom of their experience. Knowledge is powerful when it comes to decision-making, and the more knowledge Architects have, the broader their perspective can be.

Lucky and dedicated Architects might "adopt" mentors; after all, nothing provides perspective like witnessing possibilities through experienced eyes. Such viewpoints might even inspire Architects to project themselves onto a successful trajectory as they view the possibilities through the lens of their mentors' self-confidence. This can help with work, college, or graduate degree considerations.

Here are some guidelines Architects can use when finding mentors to help with the decision-making process:

- Decide before starting that making such an important decision is dynamic, and that concrete answers are likely to form only after an extended period of exploration. In other words, there are no easy answers – and good mentors don't typically provide shortcuts.
- It's alright not to have a specific goal – at least in the beginning. Avoid locking on one target: hence "mentor**s**," plural. Talk to a variety of potential mentors or read about their work.
- Seek out career counseling, ideally within the chosen field of interest. It can be daunting for someone not yet in college or in

a career to connect with mentors, but organizations and services exist to help.

- Summer internships and other job-shadowing opportunities can be immensely helpful to Architects trying to determine whether they need college.

While the Internet and other resources can provide information about a career or professional direction, there's nothing like exploring such things with those who have already been there. Because they can answer specific questions, they can tailor their information and insight for Architects in personal, relatable ways.

When Architects Choose College

Architects live for profound challenges, and higher education can offer the perfect environment for these individuals to test their limits. Those with a positive high school experience find that college provides even greater opportunities for their intellectual growth. Meanwhile, Architects who found high school lacking in choices or rigor may rejoice in their newfound ability to shape their own curriculum with a new baseline of quality.

Balanced Approach to College

Focused and Organized

As a rule, Architects are likely to commit themselves to doing well in their courses. However, they tend to invest themselves more in favored classes while doing only what the syllabus requires in less-favored subjects. They're likely to stand out in classrooms, as they connect parts of a topic in more advanced ways than other students and draw conclusions that are relatively complex. Although raw intelligence sometimes plays a role, the rational methods Architects value are more important assets in college than sheer mental acuity. Also, rote memorization, even though still present at times in this stage of academia, usually comes secondary to ideas at the university level. This emphasis invites Architects to exercise their combined Thinking and Intuitive traits to form cogent connections.

During their high school days, they may have been led to believe that they're somewhat unique in their appreciation of rationality, potentially contributing to a self-aggrandized sense of confidence. When they discover that many of their college peers are just as talented, the adjustment may take some time. Those with a balanced perspective can find their place among equals without damage to their self-esteem.

Independence and Shared Interests

Students generally embrace the freedom that college represents joyfully – and, in their own ways, independent Architects are no exception. However, although many of their peers interpret this liberty as a license to indulge their wildest libertine fantasies, Architects prefer freedom of intellect over freedom of a more carnal sort. Liberated from comparatively confining high school curricula, Architect college students suddenly find themselves encouraged to explore ideas. Learning instantly becomes less about repeating thoughts fed to them by teachers and more about forming and expressing their own thoughts.

Learning reigns supreme in these students' lives. This attitude may not have resonated with their high school classmates or their social scene. But considering the maturity and the self-selective nature of those who choose college, Architects are more likely to find a social home there. College gives these Introverts more opportunities to discover others who share their interests. These new friendships make for rare moments of comfort in a world that so often seems shallow to young Architects. Occasionally, friends from these "meetings of the minds" even become professional colleagues after they graduate.

Unbalanced Approach to College

Sometimes Argumentative

Architects often have agile minds that develop in parallel to their rising respect for rationality as they mature. But some among them reference only their preconceptions and well-established ideas when facing new information. They're secure in ideas which have served them well in the past and may have even brought them recognition as "intellectuals." In

college, this security can lead to an argumentative style, which, if taken to excess, interferes with learning. When these Architects fixate on the minor misconceptions that abound everywhere, they miss the bigger picture. They may debate heatedly, sparring over static principles or semantics, all the while ignoring broader truths more relevant to the discussion.

A boorish, argumentative style is often the product of insecurity. Architects who feel a need to prove themselves may attack others' ideas ferociously to gain a sense of intellectual superiority – often falsely. Architects have no problem wielding their intelligence like a weapon when they wade into verbal battle. However, their winnings, if anything, merely inflate their sense of self. Beating people in arguments rarely advances intellectual growth or brings new knowledge to the table. Teachers and fellow students may quickly tire of Architects who focus more on dominating others instead of considering opposing opinions or new information.

Furthermore, Architects may find worthy challengers to their arguments in college. Where once they were more proficient than their high school classmates in making arguments and debating, they may now find themselves matched – or surpassed. Where once they stood proud and fearless, they might suddenly provide more "defense" than "debate" in college. This can cause them to doubt what they trusted about themselves for so long, producing a crisis of confidence. If Architects decide they aren't as smart as they once thought, their whole world shakes.

Too Serious

An appreciation for gaining knowledge and intellectual development is admirable. However, living life too seriously can stifle chances for a full range of experiences. Disciplined Architects won't subscribe to lives of debauchery so common in college, even for a brief period. In fact, some shun even benign pleasures, even though college can be a buffet of such pleasures and a wonderful setting for exploring one's humanity.

Ralph Waldo Emerson said, "First, be a good animal." There are parts of the human experience that Architects can't experience through reading, writing, or other intellectual engagement. Some may deprive

themselves of a full understanding of topics they study by not setting a foundation that comes from experiencing life more fully. Everything – even the remotest science – touches humanity on some level. For these Architects, the stuff of life from which they may need to draw relevant conclusions during their academic and professional lives might forever remain remote theory because they chose an unduly serious path – especially in college, with its advantageous freedoms.

Rebalancing Their Approach to College

The Critical Mind as a Tool, Not a Weapon

Architects' tendency to question everything isn't a problem when they divorce the probing from their ego and hold the truth to be the final goal. Practicing a solid amount of tact is also helpful. When voiced respectfully and honestly, skepticism born of genuine critical thinking can be an asset in academia. It's fine to expect facts to back up assertions, and Architects have every right to compare their knowledge to what others tell them. However, the difference between stubbornness and astuteness is the objectivity applied when Architects test information.

What this means in a school environment is the ability to ask firm questions and admit ignorance with equal discipline. Architects demand facts, and they feel satisfied when they learn something new or when new information corrects an error or reveals a prior lack of understanding. These students aren't resentful and argumentative when teachers contradict them with good information – they're grateful.

Here are some guidelines Architects can use to ensure they're taking a more genuine approach to challenging others in college:

- Don't confuse knowledge and understanding with identity. When such confusion happens, protective egos make the arguments, not honest students who want to learn. Becoming overly emotional is a sure sign that your ego is coming into play.
- Practice active listening. Paraphrase back to individuals what they've said. This accomplishes two things: (1) it shows others that you understand their assertions, and (2) it forces you to pay full attention before rumbling through with your own opinions.

- Make peace with opposing views. In college, there are likely to be many opposing views. Fighting them and the people who express them is potentially exhausting – and likely not to accomplish anything.
- Choose battles wisely. Consider that not every seemingly erroneous statement needs correction. This especially applies if the same argument reasserts itself again and again without any apparent progress. Sometimes letting something alone – or letting it go – is the best solution. Check your motivations and the likelihood of accomplishing anything to determine whether a debate is of any value.
- Try asking questions without responding. Gather information first. There's likely plenty of time for critical dissection later.

Critical thinking can be a powerful tool for Architects who genuinely want to learn something new in college. However, it must be safeguarded by respect for objectivity. Architects love learning, and they generally have an endgame in mind, attaching a sense of purpose to their educational endeavors. This practicality can help them frame the right questions in the right way. Arguing for the sake of arguing serves mostly to exhaust the participants, and Architects need energy to keep their minds open.

Carpe Diem in College

Serious-minded Architects may regard social and extracurricular pursuits in college as superfluous. Students can earn respectable and useful degrees by heading straight to class and going directly home afterward. But a college campus is a unique environment where a little exploration outside of class can nearly overwhelm students with opportunities.

Just as college life extends beyond the classroom, it also encompasses more than just parties. Hanging out and sipping a leisurely cup of coffee in the student union has often produced valuable, lifelong friendships. If Architects' academic interests include political science or social psychology, extending those interests by joining political and civic organizations can present exposure to diverse people. *Carpe diem*, or "seizing the day," at college can require Architects to enlarge their comfort zones. The loss they're likely to experience by not grabbing the opportunities offered is a sense of regret when their future world-weary selves reflect on them years later.

Finding a social niche filled with experiences can be difficult for some Introverts, including Architects. But college may be one of the times in life that offers the most opportunities. Here are some steps they can take toward expanding their social horizons:

- Woody Allen said, "80% of life is showing up." For Architects who factor in their social lives, that figure is more like 95%. Show up to events and activities advertised on campus, like on flyers, bulletin boards, and social media. Then sample some of the activities going on. No commitment is typically necessary beyond showing up (though mind the rules of any event attended).
- Join a study group. Although many study groups seem serious and therefore sedate, with the right people, they can be low-key social events as well as learning opportunities. Because they center around a specific goal – studying – everyone's attention can easily slip into casual conversation during breaks or when the work's done.
- Commit to trying something new and different every week. Write it on a calendar or a to-do list, and treat it like any other obligation.
- Decide to pepper the average week with some fun. There's nothing wrong with doing so, and it can be a tremendous stress-buster. Go to a concert, or take a walk in the park.

College is more than earning a degree. For some Architects, it might even be a rite of passage where they considerably enlarge both their knowledge base and their sense of self.

Lifelong Learning

Lifelong learning goes beyond the rigors of school. A return to academia is a choice, and older Architects may discover they're ready for courses they once assumed were irrelevant. Beyond that, these types find themselves open to new learning experiences and experimentation throughout their lives, fully embracing types of education less driven by occupational considerations. This is ideal, as time and wisdom broaden their distinct perspectives and interests. By and large, Architects never stop learning.

Balanced Lifelong Learning

Learning Never Stops

Architects usually have practical reasons for learning, even if the reasons aren't always obvious even to themselves. This is especially true when they learn something to satisfy their need for progress and innovation. If they want to design new solar panels, they can become engineers. If they evolve, for example, to owning companies that specialize in solar panels, then they can educate themselves in the intricacies of business and marketing. They never stop adapting, so they never stop learning. However, lifelong learning encompasses much more than just supplementing their job-related knowledge and understanding.

Gathering knowledge and understanding for personal enrichment isn't a foreign idea to Architects. Learning new skills or exploring different topics just for enjoyment tends to play a part in most Architects' lives, even though they're often investing that energy into their work. As job experiences grow, Architects often train in different aspects of their current or adjacent fields. However, irrespective of professional training demands, Architects still hunger for knowledge, so they tend to embrace more leisurely types of learning, as life and time allow.

Unlimited Choices

Architects may find they're more fulfilled when they balance the ratio between necessary, job-related learning and voluntary enrichment learning. How much time they invest in non-career learning and where they invest that time are subjective. Lifestyle considerations such as work schedules, personal energy, and family and community duties can also come into play. Ambitious Architects may need to consciously carve out time for these extra pursuits outside of their careers.

Architects' rationality can help them appreciate a vast array of learning opportunities as chances to grow, round out their lives, and bring greater happiness, even if the opportunities expand their comfort zones. Sometimes an escape from the usual can be refreshing, stimulating mental processes and the creative imagination and providing great joy in the process. Still, Architects are likely to prefer topics with some challenge and complexity. Anything that involves a system is attractive to them, as they can find new ways to manipulate it. The technical

side of cooking, gardening, and even fine art – if explored from a strong methodological perspective rather than from an emotional or inspirational viewpoint – may attract them.

Unbalanced Lifelong Learning

Learning That's Excessively Grave

Lifelong learning is a different experience from academic learning or career training. Some Architects may have difficulty grasping a more leisurely approach to education. Most spend their lives as serious students defending their intellectual positions with stubborn passion. Dropping that aggressive or defensive position may be hard for those who can't shake the attitude that learning is serious (and maybe even competitive.)

Strictly purpose-driven lives are often productive and successful, but learning new and different subjects can be a chance to explore life in a lighter way that brings happiness. Joyous people might even argue that happiness itself is a serious business. Architects who select only stern, utilitarian learning experiences may reflect a worldview that lacks ecstasy or wonder. Placing the same gravity on extra-occupational learning can cause them to miss opportunities for a larger life filled with a greater sense of fulfillment.

Mistaking Gentleness for Weakness

Architects have little patience for what they consider weakness, which often includes emotional vulnerability. They're likely to find such perceived softness in opt-in learning situations, which are usually made up of volunteers who just want to become better at certain skills or gain a better layman's understanding. The context of such courses demands a softer and more patient approach, which can cause immature Architects to doubt their rigor.

People with the Architect personality type tend to see no value in learning from the soft-hearted, but that would be one of the biggest mistakes they could make. Those who haven't come to terms with their need for greater emotional intelligence may reject classes that appear too "touchy-feely." If the classroom atmosphere feels too gentle, it may

not matter if the material taught is substantial; the atmosphere alone may make the wrong impression on more stubborn Architects. But the truth is, a more relaxed approach may be necessary to balance out their lives a bit. Rejecting a course based on its atmosphere may rob them of information they crave.

Rebalancing Lifelong Learning

A Lighter Approach to Learning

There's no reason that learning must always be deadly serious – and life tends to contain less joy that way. Architects can fall into a pattern where they treat all education as "heavy" and full of purpose. They tend to take themselves seriously, and because appreciation for knowledge and learning is one of their strengths and part of their identity, they take education just as seriously.

Lifelong learning provides Architects with a chance to add some joy to their learning experiences. It may start with permitting themselves to broaden their scope from narrow utilitarianism to education for the fun of it. There's no sin in learning about a topic just because it brings fulfillment. Gaining a skill or knowledge for pleasure, free of anxiety and demands, can renew an overall love of learning – and perhaps even life.

British comedian John Cleese gave us the aphorism, "He who laughs most, learns best." True or not, the lighthearted nature of the quote might be something Architects want to consider as they explore the world of lifelong learning. Those who decide to test the principle can try the following:

- Go on the Internet, or order a catalog from a local college's adult learning department.
- Find their offerings for the next semester or quarter.
- Mark all the courses that comply with this description: "It could be fun." The courses can be useful, but taking one solely as a lark might be better. Think pottery, cooking, acting, painting with watercolors.
- If time is available, consider taking one of them.

It may be helpful for Architects who want to take a lighter, more joyful approach to learning to repeat this exercise periodically, especially the last bullet point. Their desire to gain knowledge and understanding rarely goes away, and shifting their motivation for learning fulfills this desire and may make Architects even more interesting, well-rounded people.

Collaboration and Lifelong Learning

As Architect students' attitudes toward learning become less grave, the environments where they learn may also become more laid-back and less aggressive. Competition is likely to give way to collaboration and more generosity toward fellow students. Teachers who work in adult learning typically show more patience, understanding the volunteer nature of attending class.

Although they can learn a lot by themselves, Architects may want to take advantage of such learning environments to develop their emotional intelligence. All it takes is opening their minds to all manner of people teaching them all manner of subjects. Accepting there are two levels in most classrooms – the *curricular level*, where the subject is the emphasis, and the *social level*, where people share a learning experience – can provide a paradigm for getting the most from adult learning situations. Architects may not have allowed the second to impact them much during their formal education. Lifelong learning opportunities may afford them a fresh chance to expand both their academic and social lives.

To begin looking at learning from a more social perspective, Architects can try the following:

- Consider taking a close friend or romantic partner to classes. This automatically sets them up as social occasions. Just be sure to participate with the rest of the students as well.
- Carry the attitude that opportunities exist for growth beyond what the syllabus offers in every classroom. For Architects, honoring their Introversion is important, but so is expanding their comfort zones, and the social side of learning may provide such expansion.
- Take classes with interactive qualities. Lectures from podiums with somewhat passive audiences often limit social opportunities – other than getting to know the backs of others' heads in the auditorium. Activity-based classes provide great opportunities for communal learning.

Architects can learn while being turned somewhat inward. There's nothing wrong with that if they feel they get what they need out of life. However, if they want to expand their lives and their learning, they may want to explore the notion of adult classes as places to develop their social side.

Conclusion

Opposing Tensions

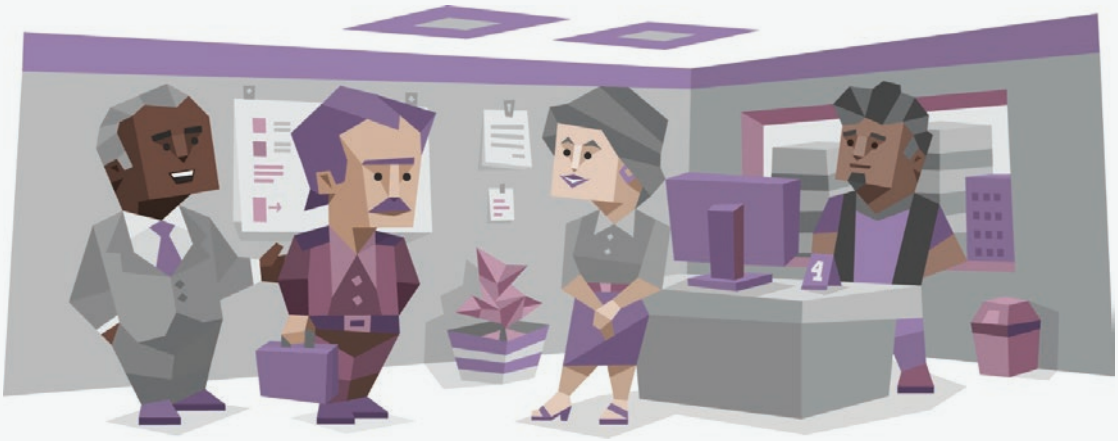
Everybody in every aspect of life has challenges to meet. Some might say that without challenges, there's no growth. The continued challenge for Architect students is the paradoxical pull of their desire for more understanding and knowledge versus their need to preserve what they already know and accept.

Learning requires change – a change of understanding, the change resulting from an increase in knowledge. Although these students can take pride in their abilities to stabilize their knowledge and set intellectual standards, they must also know when it's time to let their preconceptions fall and to let in fresh perspectives. This is their educational challenge.

Adoring Rationality

Fortunately for Architects, they're well equipped to handle the tension of critical thinking. There are rational reasons to sometimes rely on tried-and-true ideas: sometimes ideas shift a little and remain reasonable, and sometimes they shift a lot – and remain reasonable. Then again, occasionally there are rational reasons to explode established ideas and start again with a new paradigm.

Because Architects have such an affinity for all things rational, they can simply appeal to that standard to allow them to sort out what to keep and what to change. Moments of struggle or weakness often have their best outcomes when people know and trust their own strengths. That knowledge takes objectivity and honesty. Architects are capable of that – and so much more.



Professional Development

This chapter explores what can help make Architects successful in professional arenas, and it gives some guidance on potential career paths. Considering how inwardly focused their energy is and how much emphasis they place on efficiency and innovation, they may find satisfying work difficult to come by. Once they find a field that fulfills them, though, they are propelled forward by a sense of personal pride to display the best work possible. At the very least, they acquiesce to a workplace that meets their minimum requirements, then begin to change the environment little by little until it matches their personal standards.

We'll start by looking broadly at the ways Architects approach working life, including their strengths and the challenges they face. Next, we'll see how people with this personality type can apply their dedicated efficiency to getting the job they want. Then we'll look at a few fields that may be a good match for them. To help them make wise decisions as they explore their professional potential, we'll also talk about some facets that make certain work avenues unfulfilling for them. We'll even touch on some potential alternative career opportunities Architects may find exciting.

The final sections will offer a detailed look at how Architects relate to each of the four Role groups on the job, including specific advice on dealing with some likely issues arising from their differences, as well as how their similarities can create synergy. We hope the insight into bolstering everyday work interactions, troubleshooting, correcting blind spots, and creating dynamic partnerships will help make any job a pleasurable success.

Efficiency Experts

Architects are known for their ability to digest difficult, complex principles and convert them into clear, actionable ideas. They are excellent strategists, each in their way, and their imagination and confidence allow them to devise and implement challenging long-term plans without many problems. In the right career, these skills can be tremendously valuable. People with this personality type excel at jobs that involve planning, strategy, and theoretical rigor. Many Architects serve as project managers, system engineers, and marketing strategists.

Architects often say that the best thing about their job, whatever that job may be, is using creativity to solve complex problems or systemic issues. In other words, people with this personality type don't want to check entry #319 in the accounting journal; they want to figure out why that entry was wrong in the first place – and what can be done about it.

Architects value effectiveness and competence above all else, so their ideal careers reward personal initiative and determination. They uphold lofty standards and tend to become rankled when people advance because of connections or bravado rather than merit. There is no easier way to lose an Architect's respect than to value social skills or relationships above professional competence.

Analytically Creative

Architects value excellent analytics and creative skills, and they strive to practice and develop expertise in those areas. They are brilliant strategists and planners and do best when working alone or in small teams. They thrive in fields where they can combine their imagination, open-mindedness, and strategic thinking skills. They're usually fascinated by research, pattern-seeking, hypotheses, and possibilities. Often, Architects have lofty dreams and ambitions, but they may hide them, even from their closest friends.

Regardless of their chosen field, Architects are problem-solvers at heart. Nothing fascinates them more than finding a flaw in a system and devising an effective, innovative solution. They often apply the same skills to gain professional recognition and advancement.

Their inclination and dedication to analytical creativity make Architects skilled engineers, military strategists, programmers, system analysts, lawyers, and freelance consultants. Their quiet determination and sharp reasoning skills grant them a distinct advantage over other personality types when it comes to thinking strategically within, and about, their careers.

Need for Challenge

Architects rely heavily on their intelligence, and they apply themselves more earnestly when a job tests their problem-solving skills. Problems, by their nature, are novel – or someone would have already solved them. Architects are, therefore, more likely to crave evolution in their challenges rather than routinely address familiar problems. They want to have an in-depth knowledge of their foundation, then develop upon it to create lasting improvement.

If there is a system that needs rethinking or a chronic issue that keeps rearing its ugly head, Architects are among the best to address it. They aren't afraid to work through a Gordian Knot of a problem – in fact, they're likely to rate their job satisfaction higher when there are enough issues to keep their job interesting. For people with this personality type, intellectual challenges are the lifeblood of existence.

Habitually Pondering

Architects' fondness for planning, strategizing, and substantial pondering makes them ideal for jobs where leadership encourages employees to explore innovative ideas. Even in jobs that don't need creative thinking per se, Architects often find themselves considering new perspectives. The constant brainstorming feeds their preferences for working independently and meeting challenges.

Employers who request feedback get thoughtful summaries from Architects, but only if they allow enough time for thorough analyses. Architects dislike having to assess something without fully considering everything first. However, in many cases, they may have been playing with ideas and considering possible improvements all along. Depending on the job and their exposure to its different aspects, it can be hard to catch Architects by surprise; they are always looking for solutions.

Alone, but Not a Loner

Architects are unlikely to choose or enjoy customer-facing or teamwork-based careers. However, those who take a balanced approach to socializing adapt to the demands of the workplace while finding ways to enjoy a little solitude. Introverts isolate themselves to different degrees, but all crave time to themselves to collect their thoughts and to restore the energy social situations tend to drain from them. Architects provide a defining example of Introversion.

Their preference for solitude may extend beyond their social tendencies. They prefer to slow down and figure out how a project or plan will work before carrying it out, which is easier to do without social pressure to perform. Some workplaces are noisier than others. Architects who understand the importance of being socially present manage to find ways to ponder in quiet seclusion while maintaining enough social presence to fit into their workplace culture.

Finding Opportunity

Knowing Architects' general attitude toward work that's fulfilling and how they approach it, we can now turn to what they can do to get there in the first place.

Making Contact

When it comes to job hunting, Architects are unlikely to excel at networking and socializing – the primary means of getting a job for many other personality types. What they do bring to the table, however, is the ability to plan and an enthusiasm to perfect and improve upon their skill set. Therefore, many people with this personality type do just fine without an extensive social network.

The good news is that all four types in the Analyst Role know how to plan. To find a job, Architects should think about what they want to achieve in life and then work backward to engineer several possible action plans. Finding out what the first steps could be, mapping out the potential channels, crafting the introductory e-mail, presenting the arguments – these things come naturally to Architects, who shouldn't hesitate to exploit such strengths.

Not many people have the willpower or imagination necessary to come up with a highly targeted approach, but one good e-mail sent to the right person is often much better than 100 random applications.

Outside Interests

Not all companies think to ask, but organizations rarely want employees with no life outside of work. Architects should take some time to think about the hobbies they already enjoy doing, or those they really want to begin, and include that information on a résumé or mention it in an interview. There are plenty of opportunities out there – they can hone in on a chosen art form, take a course to increase their knowledge base, or finish writing a short story. It needn't be forced – if becoming a more appealing candidate is part of the inspiration to do something exciting and worthwhile, so be it.

Such projects don't need to relate to the job, either. Anything that shows Architects as creators can go on a résumé. This presents them as more attractive and versatile candidates and gives breathing room during interviews. Answering a question like, "Describe a situation where you used your problem-solving skills," is much, much easier with projects and anecdotes ready for discussion.

People with the Architect personality type burrow into their hobbies, and such deep expertise can be useful in their chosen careers. Employers are no longer reluctant to Google prospective candidates or check out links included in a résumé. Applicants can get bonus points if their résumés state that their hobbies include running a blog about that specific field.

Preparing for the Interview

Architects can certainly spend some time improving their presentation skills, whatever their natural ability. However, when they have an interview coming up, they can engage in radical over-analysis, trying to prepare thoroughly for every possible imagined scenario. This is a trap most Intuitive types fall for too easily.

Of course, this level of consideration means they can't possibly prepare for everything properly, and they can even exhaust themselves ahead of the interview, undermining their chances. They might also ignore

"common" interview questions in favor of more unlikely "original" but seemingly more threatening scenarios. Architects need to be aware of the most common interview techniques and questions so they aren't caught off-guard by something like, "What is your biggest weakness?" Answers such as "Perfectionism" or "I work too hard" may be honest, but they're also common enough to be clichés. When an interviewer is looking for self-awareness and introspection, responses that appear to be "canned" cut off opportunities for more meaningful discussions.

It's important to be prepared to answer template questions, especially in the preliminary stages of a job search, with something approaching enthusiasm. In some cases, recruiters don't even know much about the roles and are simply going through checklists. If Architects go in expecting this, regardless of their personal feelings on the efficacy of such an approach, they will prevent confidence from clouding their judgment and disillusionment from overshadowing a good interview.

Finally, Architects tend to be very good candidates in many fields, but they often find it difficult to "sell" themselves, consequently losing out to less qualified – but better prepared – candidates. Architects should work to be more comfortable highlighting their achievements and passions.

Jobs and General Skill Sets

Let's look at some specific jobs that tend to fit Architects the best. This list is by no means comprehensive, as Architects can succeed in any career they choose. Similarly, even "suitable" careers won't be ideal for all Architects. Everyone must determine what career is the most appropriate for them, meets their needs, and brings them fulfillment and personal satisfaction.

For Architects who are already employed, this may serve as a confirmation or an explanation why they're happy or unhappy in their current role. We can't tell anyone how to be successful or happy, but we do hope the following material offers some insight for Architects making personal career decisions.

Innovation and Design

Engineering and design are broad categories for disciplines that use science, math, design techniques, and ingenuity to create machines, structures, or systems. People in these fields create new products, improve old ones, and find new applications for existing products. Such careers allow Architects to tap into their creativity, a trait that many overlook but which tends to play a key role in Architects' overall happiness.

Architects have a knack for spotting trends and tendencies in the noise of irrelevant details, then using that information to improve an existing system or build a better one. Their curiosity and desire for efficiency make them excellent candidates for engineering and design roles. Furthermore, most engineers and designers labor alone over a drafting table, a computer, or a workbench much of the time, satisfying Architects' "lone wolf" nature.

Research and Science

Architects have a deep need to discover how everything works. They love discovery, and they're also fascinated by the patterns that reveal themselves through research. Architects take the initiative to explore uncharted territory and find different approaches to old disciplines.

Researchers and scientists with the Architect personality type admire others with similar drive and abilities, and they can collaborate successfully if they feel they're dealing with equals – or those of superior ability and experience whom they can look up to. Fields that involve research and science can fulfill Architects' need for forward-looking potential.

Medicine

In the medical field, Architects make thorough diagnosticians and practitioners. What they may lack in bedside manner, they make up

for in competence. Their Intuitive trait, tempered by their Judging trait, allows Architect physicians to quickly assess a constellation of symptoms and discern an accurate diagnosis. They use a similar big-picture approach to develop effective treatment recommendations. Architects in medicine may look to specialist roles where they can be master of their domain, the "resident expert."

Strategy

It's no accident that Architects are part of a Role group called Analysts. Architects envision and manipulate systems, mentally dissecting them, identifying areas for improvement, then rebuilding them in a useful way. Calling this section "Strategy" is cheating a little bit – everything Architects do is strategic in some way, but not all strategic jobs fit neatly into categories. So, this section serves as a catch-all. Some of the roles where Architects can excel, and which also provide fulfillment: business administrator, management consultant, project manager, military officer, educational consultant, or investment analyst.

What do these jobs have in common? They all address far-reaching problems and offer opportunities to devise and implement new strategies – in other words, what Architects do best.

Challenging Career Qualities

Some professional situations may be less suitable or comfortable for Architects, obstructing their path to success and happiness. Of course, Architects shouldn't discount any career merely on face value, because when these adaptable individuals put their minds to it, they can do anything. They can, however, objectively evaluate specific jobs against their own needs, values, and limits. Such questions are essential to good decision-making. To aid Architects in investigating job opportunities, let's look at some career aspects and circumstances that present prominent challenges for people with this personality type.

Lack of Intellectual Stimulation

Architects' minds are both their greatest gift and their greatest curse. When a work environment is a good fit, people with this personality type are quickly noticed and appreciated; if not, they may feel endlessly frustrated by inefficiencies and missed opportunities. Architects tend

to have many transferable skills and shouldn't hesitate to promote them, or even look for greener pastures when a job isn't a good match.

Architects need a great deal of intellectual stimulation and challenge to be satisfied. Unlike some other personality types, they never actually satisfy their curiosity; they're always looking for new puzzles and pursuing new angles on unsolved problems. For Architects, many career paths may feel unsuitable, as they may feel as though their employers underutilize their primary skills.

It's imperative that Architects learn to find ways to use their strategic thinking skills whenever and wherever they can – even in positions that may be unstimulating. If they find that a role is unsuitable, they won't be able to shake the gnawing feeling that they're in the wrong place, no matter how much they are paid or how stable the position may be.

Too Much Social Interaction

In office environments, relationships can be an issue for Architects. As in many other areas of their lives, they rarely exert extraordinary effort to make friends and allies in the office. If they neglect professional relationships, however, they risk stifling their development and missing both personal and professional opportunities. Even casual office relationships can be beneficial, so it's important to keep an open mind and consider getting to know colleagues better.

Architects may adopt a "lone wolf" mentality and focus on their desire to complete work as independently as possible. Rather than viewing others as resources or sources of support, Architects tend to believe that most people they work with are either energy vultures or unnecessary distractions. They tend to approach their conversations with such individuals in a less-than-congenial way.

The Curse of Routine

Most jobs have mind-numbing, monotonous work on occasion. Architects who refuse to temper their frustration with the mundane, those who have no tolerance for routine, are likely to flounder from time to time. Almost every job offers tedium, and Architects occasionally face the challenge that their job has no challenge.

Architects who can't handle unchallenging "busy work" may find that they lack any enthusiasm, which may affect the quality of their work. They may also try to optimize their busywork – they often waste a lot of time and energy trying to make their work better than it needs to be.

Pondering Takes Time

Architects may get caught up in their ruminations, which can cut into valuable work time. Those who take a balanced approach understand that pondering intellectual contributions may not always be as important as the bottom line or the schedule. Excessive analyses may not be a problem – unless they slow down a company's progress or cause missed deadlines.

People with this personality type have a talent for reconstructing systems, and they may become frustrated when they can't use those talents. But not all jobs call for such analyses. Those who don't appreciate the limits and focus of their job may experience disdain from coworkers and try the patience of their superiors. Their supervisors may regard them as too impractical to carry out what they hired them to do.

Career Alternatives

Self-Employment

Many people find the notion of self-employment quite scary, but these days, even traditionally employed people rarely have true job security or guarantees of advancement. Consequently, working for themselves can be a viable option, and it offers many benefits that align with Architect values, including flexibility, independence, and control over projects.

Furthermore, self-employment eliminates a major hurdle Architects encounter in traditional work environments: a lack of control over their duties. Self-employed people have more control over the type of work they engage in; though this still includes administrative duties on some level, but at least they have more of a hand in filtering what comes in. Choosing the self-employed route also appeals to Architects' sense of self-determination. Once they put their mind to something – acquiring more clients, diversifying their work, increasing their expertise in their chosen field – Architects are formidable forces. They have the same amount of work, but they can be their own boss.

Supplementing Their Knowledge Base

Most Architects realize during their school years that they excel at absorbing new knowledge, especially of a technical nature. If they choose self-employment, they can leverage this strength by seizing every opportunity to learn and experiment with something new. For instance, the Internet offers myriad courses and lessons, or they can join a career-focused group where they can gather information from other members. Even if a piece of information doesn't yield any immediate benefits, it may prove useful at some point.

Life is full of opportunities, and Architects have a substantial advantage over other personality types when it comes to retaining knowledge, so they would be wise to continue expanding their skill set at every opportunity. In addition to learning more about their chosen field, Architects can benefit from exploring areas that are unfamiliar to them. Learning about what is unknown can open new doors and boost self-confidence as well.

Capitalizing on a Hobby

Architects often pursue hobbies that could turn into a source of income in the future. The hobby can be anything, such as crafting innovative woodwork, building custom personal computers, making music, or consulting to improve communities. Some Architects want to change the world, whereas others focus on local or personal matters. When people with this personality type truly enjoy a hobby, and if they can retain the safety net of regular employment, they may create the next "big thing." If they divert some financial resources to the hobby, so much the better.

This approach is common among Architects, especially those who are well paid but not intellectually challenged. The right hobbies provide Architects with opportunities to do things that truly excite and inspire them, without the constraints of employer-employee relationships. If they create value, they can likely find a way to become profitable in time and can tick another important box on their happiness checklist – independence.

A side note for ambitious Architects: people with this personality type are bound to overthink things and get bogged down trying to determine the path that's right for them. They should take time to think and reflect – but try not to obsess over details. Architects are usually at their best when they're relaxed and confident in their skills.

When it comes to the professional world, it doesn't matter which path Architects choose, as long as it feels right and serves as a source of inspiration. Although this is an idealistic perspective for many people, if any type can devise a system that makes one thing adapt to the purpose of another – adapting a hobby to an income, for example – it's Architects.

Entrepreneurial Spirit

Of course, there is no point in trying to start a business without a promising idea. This is where Architects' ability to come up with unusual connections enables them to shine. Anyone can think up a product, but it takes an imaginative mind to come up with an idea, product, or solution that could grow into an innovative business venture.

If they decide to try their hand at entrepreneurship, they can use their creativity and strategic thinking skills to devise an interesting way to fulfill an existing need (or create one). They aren't afraid to experiment. Architects can be excellent entrepreneurs, having the imagination necessary to develop an innovative idea, the know-how to create a sound business model, and the willpower to keep going in tough times. However, they may want to partner with someone who enjoys the meet-and-greets and sales pitches so necessary to the start-up process.

Workplace Cooperation Between Roles

Architects are solitary and more likely to form relationships with their work colleagues based on mutual respect and efficiency rather than a desire to be friends. This section covers workplace pairings between Architects and all four Roles, including brief overviews of potential synergies and obstacles, as well as ways Architects can find balance and work well with other types.

Architect-Analyst Cooperation

Work relationships between Architects and other Analysts are hardly like peering into a mirror. Rest assured, even with their similarities, plenty of nuances and differences remain, which can be positive or negative in a professional environment. The results depend as much upon Architects and what approach they decide to take as they do on the behaviors and attitudes of their colleagues.

Balanced Architect-Analyst Cooperation

Lofty and Logical Language

Architects and other Analysts often find themselves "speaking the same language." They both make rational arguments and engage in conceptual discussions. Although they draw on facts, their focus is on big-picture ideas and concepts. Small talk does not interest either party, and they may find each other a relief from the tedium of water-cooler chat. As puzzle-solvers, Architects and other Analysts explore systems and concepts, engaging in "what if" discussions with each other. They share their ideas for improving any system or enterprise they come across.

Architects and other Analysts can be a perfect match when it comes to brainstorming or bouncing ideas off each other. Brainstorming sessions between these two are likely to extend into a series of discussions, as both take time to ponder the different facets of an idea. In the workplace, such interactions yield many benefits. For example, others might be able to feed a problem to this duo and pull out a solution a few minutes later. Analysts and other Architects delight in being a sort of black-box solutions generator, fueled by their affinity for ideas mixed with potential solutions.

Covering Each Other's Bases

Architects are adept at reverse-engineering any system; they can take a deconstructed methodology and apply or cut concepts until a system runs optimally. This type is not one for flourishes, instead preferring minimalist approaches focused on effectiveness, simplicity, and elegance. Although they can be creative, their talent lies less in creation and more in application of abstract concepts.

When it comes to problem-solving, Architects are masters of fixing issues that have long-term implications in a broader structure, and they can be resolute if not stubborn once a decision is made. When they can't rely on perfect results, they can lean on Extraverted and Prospecting Analysts to help them round out their solution by asking for critiques, suggestions, or even a devil's advocate to test a solution's soundness.

For example, Architects who want to create a managerial position for themselves might perform in-depth research to determine what the new position would entail and how to succeed, but they also might take the advice of respected Analyst colleagues. The Architects might focus on optimizing key performance indicators – sales and customer acquisition, for example. However, Analyst colleagues may point out that they failed to consider employee satisfaction in the process. Working alongside Analyst colleagues, Architects can implement more balanced versions of their original plans.

Unbalanced Architect-Analyst Cooperation

Constant Competition

One of the biggest pitfalls Architects and other Analysts can face is competition. Being a somewhat rare type, Architects may not be used to having another Analyst in the room, and this can be uncomfortable – especially when the other Analyst shares their specific interest. In certain career settings with a high concentration of Analysts, the competition can be intense, particularly for those who may be drawn to leadership positions. Although Architects and other Analysts aren't prone to drama in an emotional sense, they can be stubborn enough to cause workplace turmoil nonetheless.

If Architects and other Analysts become competitive with each other, they may become entrenched in opposing ideas or criticize each other. These types tend to feel scorn for others' mistakes or flawed logic. Analyst character Sheldon Cooper from *The Big Bang Theory* is an often-mentioned archetype: just as Sheldon's Analyst friends on the show can be hurt by his judgments, Architects and other Analysts in the workplace can wound each other if they exchange harsh criticism.

There is also a chance that the two will unite their competitive spirit against others. Architects, when fueled by the desire to trample competitors, can quickly turn toxic in the workplace. Adding another Analyst to fan the flames can make a situation go from bad to terrible.

Innovation in an Intuitive Vacuum

Innovation for innovation's sake is not innovation – innovation demands applicability and real change. Although most Architects would agree with the preceding statement, they sometimes find themselves swept up in the ideations of enthusiastic Analyst colleagues. The pair may forgo traditional company standards, working to outdo not only each other but also external competitors. Even if they create a masterpiece as a result, they may come back to their workplace with an amazing plan/design/patent only to find that there is no place for it in the current structure. Innovation, though well and good, doesn't have as much effect when it can't be implemented.

Going further, Architects, when alone, have issues admitting fallibility once they've decided that they're right. Add other Intuitive Thinking types who share Architects' opinions, and it creates a very logical – but every bit as misinformed – echo chamber where only their opinions matter. To the rest of their colleagues, Architects and other Analysts may seem unapproachable at best, intimidating at worst.

Alternatively, Architects and other Analysts can find themselves in a quagmire of genius if they produce too many great ideas while brainstorming together. Each new idea requires resources and entails costs, and the pair may become trapped in their own cleverness. At some point, they may need to pull in a Sentinel or an Explorer to lend a practical perspective. Established authors often advise new writers to "murder their darlings," or get rid of beautifully written sentences that don't advance the story; at times, Architects and other Analysts may need to kill their "darling" ideas for the practical good of a project or business.

When they sell themselves on their own concepts, Architects and other Analysts can be stubborn. Two or more together can be nearly unmovable.

Rebalancing Architect-Analyst Cooperation

Formalizing Competition

Competition is not a terrible thing, especially if the results are beneficial to an organization. Problems arise when competition detracts from a company's mission. Analysts and Architects can stray from goals and focus more on outdoing one another. To remedy this, they can formalize any competition.

A formal competition implies a degree of good sportsmanship, allows others to participate willingly or decline to participate, and returns a sense of cooperation. This sort of competition ends up being a win-win because all parties involved seek to improve rather than sabotage. Architects can formalize a competition by taking the following steps.

- Notice challenges from Analyst colleagues. They may say something minor like, "I believe it would be better to do the project this way,"

or something more explicit like, "I believe that way is wrong."

- Create your own counter idea/plan/design that aligns with the company's mission.
- Shoot an email or have a conversation with the Analyst colleague that suggests a formal competition. For example, "I thought you had a clever idea, and I'd like to test it against mine. Are you up for a friendly competition?"
- If they agree, clarify terms of the competition and inform supervisors.
- Keep track of the competition and make sure it doesn't stray from the company's mission.

In the end, this pair will either have a cleanly defined competition or no competition at all – in which case they can do their work in peace. If they choose to "duke it out," however, both are likely to gain and grow from two (or more) great Analyst minds colliding.

Tempering Innovation

Innovation can be amazing, if there's a clear need for it. Without a clearly defined goal, it's simply invention for fun, which is fine if that's the intention, but a waste of time and resources if it isn't. When Architects join forces with Analyst colleagues, they may find themselves swept up into enthusiastic ideation, but they can temper this by checking themselves and determining whether a project is still on task according to their company's standards.

When they temper their need to innovate, Architects and Analyst colleagues can focus on what is really needed by the company, instead of what they *think* the company needs. Any ideas that aren't relevant to the company's mission can be documented and perhaps used later. Before beginning to work on a project, Architects can:

- Write the mission and objective of the company in large bold letters on a brainstorming whiteboard/shared document/project agenda.
- Suggest that the roles for each member be based on those objectives.

- Check on the team's progress at reasonable intervals.
- Create an open document where team members can store creative and innovative ideas pertaining to the project.
- Periodically run the idea document by supervisors throughout the duration of the project.
- Take all approvals back to the team and implement them into the project.

By following these tips, Architects can optimize how they use their energy, lessening effort spent on projects that don't need innovation and re-directing their ideas (and the ideas of other Analysts) toward areas that need their analytical creativity. They must accept beforehand that not every suggestion will be taken – different perspectives and additional information can make an idea unexpectedly untenable.

Architect-Diplomat Cooperation

Architects and Diplomats prefer to advance the "big picture" rather than fiddle with mundane details of facilitation. Both can absorb knowledge almost subconsciously and then incorporate it into a larger constellation of meaning, often connecting things in profound ways. This similarity in style and shared love for creative thought give them ample opportunity to combine their talents.

Balanced Architect-Diplomat Cooperation

Big-Picture Plans

Like Architects, Diplomats thrive on big-picture visions and bold creativity. Together, these two are imaginative, abstract thinkers. They

spot strange patterns and generate wholly unexpected concepts. Together, they combine their imaginative firepower to hatch big plans and tackle major challenges. They also make sure to restrain their creativity so that it matches the objectives of their work environment. This is where Architects' Judging trait comes in handy: in the context of a working relationship, Architects can ground Diplomats' sometimes bigger-than-life ideas, making sure to combine Diplomats' endless optimism with their own brand of pragmatism.

In the workplace, this pragmatism could look like Architects tempering Diplomats' ideas by asking questions like, "'How do we do this?" "What are the beginning steps?" "What is the main objective?" and "What are some obstacles we're likely to encounter?" These two are not blinded by the status quo, and they are willing to venture into entirely unfamiliar territory, but they also make sure to have a plan that fits well with their workplace objective.

Allowing Emotion

Architects focus on systems and rationality, and Diplomats attend to human thought and emotion. Diplomats' altruistic instincts are wonderful, although at times impractical, and Architects will tell them so. Compared to Diplomats, Architects tend to be more comfortable with the impersonal world of systems and puzzles, which allows them to optimize and streamline processes. As a result, ever-rational Architects can help ensure that Diplomats' efforts aren't only well intended, but also feasible and sustainable. On the other hand, they also know when to allow Diplomats to influence their own projects with humanity and warmth, making their plans easier to digest by the population at large.

Given their candor and incisiveness, Architects are likely to diagnose Diplomats' blind spots and emotional biases, then suggest course corrections and strategy enhancements that make Diplomats' initiatives feasible in the long run. Just as Diplomats accept Architects' help, Architects, when taking a balanced approach to emotion, do the same. They understand that even though they may be logically less wrong than others, social nuances that are crucial to getting a point across might escape them – something that Diplomats are more than happy to reveal to Architects.

Unbalanced Architect-Diplomat Cooperation

Lost in the Big Picture

When Architects and Diplomats work well together, they enjoy a sort of intellectual head rush. The joy of finally finding conversation partners who trade in big concepts and abstract ideas is powerful, because that shared interest presents the possibility that they can both expand their understanding. If this devolves into cliquishness, however, they may wall themselves off from other colleagues, closing their ears to more grounded viewpoints and worldviews.

Although Architects and Diplomats counterbalance some of each other's weaknesses, their similarities leave them susceptible to blind spots. They may overlook everyday, nitty-gritty details, and implementation isn't among their strong points. As a result, when they make plans without consulting more pragmatic colleagues, they may set themselves up to fail, whether by neglecting practical details or by creating incredible visions without the ability to implement them.

Empathy Versus Objectivity

Architects prioritize optimization over compassion, and their hardline rationality may leave little room for Diplomats' need for harmony. Meanwhile, Diplomats, who honor cooperation, may find that Architects accuse them of being too soft or over-emotional. When their working relationship falls into this pattern, Architects and Diplomats may lock each other out completely, refusing to engage in each other's opinions.

Their relationship may involve a lot of one-sided suggestions from Architects that are more likely to put off Diplomats than not, followed very quickly by disengagement, led by the Diplomat, who likely won't say why because they would rather avoid conflict. Architects aren't interested in adversarial conflict either, so they'll just mutually not engage each other unless required.

Over time, Architects may find that their Diplomat colleagues have disengaged from their debates entirely, given their aversion to conflict. Architects take this inability to argue a point as a moral weakness of some sort and consequently may bear down harder upon Diplomat colleagues if the opportunity presents itself. In the end, Diplomats

may see their Architect colleagues as imperious and insensitive, and Architects may see Diplomats as lacking the backbone to see a project through. Points of contention can't be resolved without open discussion, so when they disengage in this manner, Architects worsen the working relationship, reducing their chances of building consensus.

Rebalancing Architect-Diplomat Cooperation

Using the Head and the Heart

Architects looking to improve communication and cooperation with their Diplomat coworkers need to modify the way they approach conversations. Architects should take the time to discover what values are important to Diplomat coworkers to truly understand what motivates them. When Architects ask questions that combine "who" and "why," they allow Diplomats to draw upon their empathic and perceptive nature and provide heartfelt responses.

Architects should keep in mind that Diplomats don't respond well to criticism or harsh words. Architects may have no problem with (they even enjoy) criticism and debate, but Diplomats can be acutely sensitive to this type of dialogue and may even shut down, at least temporarily. Architects who take time to express their appreciation and gratitude to Diplomat colleagues, at least occasionally, can create more meaningful and productive partnerships.

Architects aren't the only ones who have to adjust their approach and expectations. Diplomats must exercise their empathy with their Architect colleagues to understand them. Architects value honest and efficient conversation, and Diplomats must learn that straightforwardness, even with difficult topics, is necessary when communicating with people with this personality type. To get an honest response from Architects, Diplomats often need to ask questions that begin with "why." Architects are likely to enjoy discussing reasons and consequences, regardless of the topic.

When Diplomats experience communication issues with Architect colleagues, they may have to leave their comfort zone to resolve such problems. Most Diplomats go out of their way to avoid confrontation;

Architects, on the other hand, respect their honesty when they take the initiative to address any issues. Rather than taking offense, they tend to thoughtfully analyze an issue and develop their own suggestions for fixing the problem.

As intelligent as Architects often are, they're notorious for lacking *emotional* intelligence. The good news: emotional intelligence can be learned and improved. The not-so-good-news: Architects tend to make comments that others may perceive as hurtful or insensitive. Communication becomes much more congenial when Diplomats understand that their Architect colleagues aren't out to offend or insult them. For Diplomats, learning to not take seemingly unfriendly responses or comments from Architects personally is key for improving communication and cooperation between them.

Fortunately, despite their differences, Architects and Diplomats have the potential to balance each other extraordinarily well. Teams with both personality types on board can bring both the head and the heart into every project, ensuring that both personal and business needs are met throughout the process. When working with Diplomats, Architects can use the following tips:

- Ask for opinions and ideas on an issue.
- Listen to responses with an open mind.
- Respond evenly and calmly, but also try to connect on a level that conveys emotion.
- Ask, "How can we move forward?"
- Reach compromises to best achieve work-related goals.
- Be forgiving – focus on progress instead of blame.

Architects often brace for conflict, so when they find friendly tolerance and interest instead, they reflect Diplomats' open, positive example, which helps to foster a more productive and pleasant workplace.

Architect-Sentinel Cooperation

Both Architects and Sentinels like to see ideal outcomes, and they have much to talk about when it comes to the usefulness of the human element in the workplace. While Architects focus more on ideological matters involving innovation, Sentinels' interests lie in sensible efficiency and taking care of others on a practical level. Both find satisfaction and self-respect in completing their tasks well, so there's common ground for them to bond and get things done.

Balanced Architect-Sentinel Cooperation

Ideas and Implementation

When they have jobs that suit them, Architects and Sentinels gravitate toward distinct functions. Architects are visionaries who assemble the building blocks of a system. Sentinels, on the other hand, efficiently attend to everyday business needs, performing practical tasks and creating order. So, how can these two work with each other and communicate successfully?

In some ways, it's a perfect match. Architects often need someone to carry out their vision. They're masters at manipulating ideas, but they do best if they partner with others who convert their ideas into something practical. Sentinels can easily fulfill that role. A stereotype of this might be the visionary CEO with the practical administrative assistant. Think of Tony Stark and Pepper Potts from the *Iron Man* movies as caricatures of Architect-Sentinel partnerships: Tony busies himself designing his technologies, and Pepper keeps Stark Industries running.

Given this example, one might picture Sentinels as subordinate to visionary Architects, but this isn't necessarily the case. Architects could

be in research positions with Sentinel bosses, for example, and they'd complement each other just the same.

Architects and Sentinels can create mutually useful and enviably productive partnerships in the workplace. If they accept each other's roles and draw on their respective strengths, both can become invaluable to the other.

Managing Details

Architects' creative imaginations can cause them to become fixated on small and relatively insignificant confounding factors. Conversely, Sentinels take the attitude that "if it comes up, we'll deal with it." Sentinels help bring Architects back from the microscopic scale and into the visual spectrum. That is how Sentinels stand out as excellent collaborators, keeping an eye on day-to-day operations, ensuring that things run smoothly, and anticipating practical challenges. When a budget needs to be upheld or a project timeline needs to be enforced, there are few better allies than Sentinels.

When they want to try something new, Architects can turn to Sentinels for a grounded point of view. Sentinels have practical savvy, and they know what's worked in the past and what hasn't. Architects might be tempted to dismiss them as stodgy, but Sentinels' insights can save precious time and energy, particularly in the initial stages of a project. In workplace partnerships, Architects and Sentinels counterbalance each other beautifully, combining idealism with know-how, vision with practicality. The likely result: the implementation of new and effective initiatives.

Unbalanced Architect-Sentinel Cooperation

Degrees of Change

There's an old saying: "Nobody likes change except a wet baby." But this isn't entirely true: Intuitive types like Architects love change (though some prefer more thorough preparation than others). They seek improvement as a matter of course because it represents growth and possibilities to them. Yet Sentinels adhere to proven standards and traditions, and they like to work within existing norms. Architects

have little regard for the status quo, especially if it gets in the way of improving a system. Sentinels may insist on doing something the "right way," according to how it's always been done; meanwhile, Architects may insist on doing it a new "right" way – regardless of how it's always been done.

Architects like radical changes, if they bring them up or a respected person carefully lays out the details, implementation, and consequences. Sentinels, however, need more incremental change that improves on existing systems in clear ways. The conflict between tradition and change is as old as humanity itself, and it can indeed create problems in the workplace. Between Architects and Sentinels, this tension can play out in the form of passive-aggressively resisting or discounting each other's contributions.

Rising Resentment

When Sentinels push for short-term specifics or plans that seem too small, Architects might judge them as unimaginative. In turn, Architects may find themselves labeled as constant agitators who won't leave "good enough" alone.

In unbalanced relationships, Architects lose respect for Sentinels' opinions, so they don't consult them regarding important decisions. As a result, they lose the benefit of Sentinels' diligent, detail-oriented approach. Although Architects may think they're better off without Sentinels' input, their unwillingness to collaborate with these colleagues can cause frustration and headaches when it's time to implement or troubleshoot projects – two areas where Sentinels excel.

To communicate more effectively, Architects may need to pull their punches a bit. On the other side, Sentinels would do well not to take Architects' criticism too personally – whether it's directed at them or others. Architects would do well to understand that Sentinels may react badly to harsh comments and off-the-cuff negative feedback. Because Sentinels are so invested in doing the work they do, maintaining balance, and ensuring things run well, they sometimes take criticism toward an organization or others very personally.

Rebalancing Architect-Sentinel Cooperation

Understanding How to Change

Nothing makes Sentinels feel better than crossing tasks off their lists, and Architects, with their continuous stream of ideas, can provide an enormous number of tasks for their Sentinel colleagues to complete. This process is only effective, however, if Architects make sure to understand the concept of sensitive, grounded change.

Change, especially when based on theories and ideas, can make Sentinels uncomfortable. Architects can allay their Sentinel coworkers' concerns and hesitation if they link their ideas and theories to practical, specific tasks. When suggesting changes to a current system – for example their company's hiring process – Architects who bring forward ideas based on leading-edge hiring theories are likely to be met with skepticism from Sentinel coworkers. To counteract this, Architects can try the following:

- Highlight your objective (for example, "increase number of customers using a cutting-edge technology").
- Create a roadmap that shows how the idea will be incorporated into the current structure, as well as what it will look like in one month, three months, six months, and so on.
- Provide a date for when the new idea will be fully integrated into the system.
- Highlight practical tasks and smaller steps, increasing the odds of results.
- Allow plenty of time for change to take place so Sentinels can feel more comfortable with the transition and be more knowledgeable of any technical aspects of the change process.

Moving beyond the status quo may seem a noble pursuit to innovative Architects, but Sentinels who prefer to uphold tradition may feel that their views have been overlooked and unappreciated. Architects should remember that overeager criticism or impatience elicits resistance from even the most supportive Sentinels.

The remedy for this potential pitfall is to focus on patience, gratitude,

and a sincere respect for the many strengths that Sentinels bring to the workplace. Specifically, Sentinels' attention to detail is an incredible benefit to Architects. It has been said that Architects (and other Analysts) create the trains but Sentinels keep them running on time. Awareness of the symbiotic nature of their workplace relationship fosters mutual respect and appreciation.

Practicing Patience and Awareness

Competition and an abundance of information can overwhelm Architect-Sentinel relationships in the workplace, but this pairing has immense potential for productive, positive interaction. Awareness is essential – especially when it comes to competitive urges, which can trigger stonewalling or unduly harsh criticism.

It's important to make sure that these two have plenty of time and space to process topics on their own. Architects, especially, need time to mull over any new subjects before they feel comfortable weighing in.

This doesn't mean that Architects and Sentinels always agree with each other or come to the same conclusions. Both should practice patience and allow each other to prove – or fail to prove – their points in their own time and in their own way. Disagreements are bound to take place, and most Architects enjoy intellectual sparring, especially with equally stubborn Sentinels – to the point they risk wasting time at work with too much theoretical jousting, particularly when on deadline. Nothing sidelines a project faster than a drawn-out discussion on theory between Architects and Sentinels. When faced with a situation like this, Architects can try the following:

- Make the decision to "put a pin" in the conversation or save it for later.
- Tell your colleague that you will discuss it further, when the schedule is less pressing – after work hours, for instance, or on another work day.
- Ask Sentinels to ground a qualitative vision or goal, such as improved customer loyalty or employee satisfaction, in concrete details. How can the goal be measured? Is it sufficiently precise? What actions can be taken to achieve it?

- Regularly ask Sentinel colleagues for advice on how to translate ideas into concrete terms, as this is their strong suit. Solicit feedback regarding which aspects of a plan should be more specific or actionable.
- If suggesting a change, support the argument by outlining tangible rather than intangible benefits.

By bridging the gap between their grandiose ideas and specific goals, Architects can win over Sentinels and pave the way for clear communication. To communicate effectively with Sentinels, Architects can ground their use of abstract terms like “vision” and “innovate” with concrete details. This might entail outlining specific benchmarks they’d like to hit as opposed to reciting a mission or vision, or perhaps they can discuss the tangible upsides of a novel approach rather than the intangible benefits.

Architect-Explorer Cooperation

Though there may seem to be little common ground between Architects and Explorers, one only needs to dig deeper. The common ground between Architects and Explorers is one where fascination with discovery drives personal achievement. They both value independence and discovery over rules and tradition. They especially enjoy turning a fixed idea on its head, creating a whole new perspective. This common ground enables Architects and Explorers to work together as innovators.

Balanced Architect-Explorer Cooperation

Combining Vision with Action

Both Architects and Explorers enjoy searching for answers. Although Architects enjoy theorizing about ideas and systems, Explorers would rather solve problems in a hands-on fashion. Architects prefer to think through potential outcomes and consequences before acting, whereas Explorers can't wait to get started. When it comes to work, the two can embark on a two-step process. Architects can generate ideas, then ask Explorers to join them in a partnership to make the ideas reality. Because people with the Architect personality type can struggle with implementation due to fixation on details, having an Explorer colleague who is more action-oriented can help move projects along.

Consider the story of Apollo 13, a NASA space mission in 1970. After a mechanical mishap, the nation wasn't sure whether the three U.S. astronauts on board the spacecraft could make it back to Earth alive. In that situation, the ground control team in Houston can be thought of as Architects (or any Analyst type). The Architect ground control team members calculated all the numbers and worked out a trajectory that could get the astronauts home.

The astronauts on board the spacecraft served as Explorers, doing the hands-on work and executing the details the Architects had provided, and they eventually got the capsule home. Communication between the ground control team and the astronauts was vital to the success of the Apollo 13 rescue. The metaphor illustrates how Explorers' and Architects' contrasting functions and styles can work together to fulfill the same goal.

Appreciating Levity

Between Architects and Explorers, the biggest issue may be the former's issue with the latter's seeming disregard of consequences. To Architects, Explorers can appear as though they're only around to have fun, with very little care for the end game. However, when Architects decide to appreciate Explorers' strengths, particularly in the workplace, wonderful things can happen.

As colleagues, Architects can help keep things on track, lending focus to their Explorer coworkers, and Explorers can help lighten the mood.

When working, this can look like Architects lightly reminding Explorers of their duties and the benefits of finishing them, while also keeping in mind that Explorers can help them to relax a bit – even Architects need a break.

Unbalanced Architect-Explorer Cooperation

Obsessive-Impulsive

Although Architects and Explorers can balance each other's strengths and weaknesses extraordinarily well, the combination has potential downsides. Architects may obsess over details and become annoyed at Explorers' inability to do the same (or even to consider the details at all). On the other hand, Explorers may become irritated with the loftiness of Architects' interests.

Explorers may be tempted to dismiss Architects as pedantic, obsessed with planning, and far too slow to act. Conversely, because Architects sometimes condescend toward people who don't inhabit their world of strategic planning and complex systems, they may dismiss Explorers' "get it done" attitude as short-sighted and reckless. If the frustrations get out of hand, communication can shut down.

Both Architects and Explorers, particularly those with the Thinking trait, can be quick to criticize the other's ideas. Although Explorers may have the advantage when it comes to taking action, Architects have the edge when it comes to strategizing and planning. Architects may determine that they're the only individuals competent enough to carry out their plans, so they may attempt to exclude Explorers from projects. Rather than playing to each other's strengths, these stubborn individuals may find themselves succumbing to contrasting tendencies rather than working in a way that benefits everyone.

Misaligned Priorities

In stark contrast to Architects, Explorers often downplay consequences. Given a choice between a bird in the hand or two in the bush, Architects will choose the two in the bush – though they may regret passing up the one in hand, with the benefit of retrospect. Explorers, on the

other hand, tend to shy away from long-term planning and prioritize immediate gains.

In the workplace, this can manifest as priority misalignment. Architects tend to focus on building lasting relationships with clients and upholding their word, whereas Explorers often favor risky ventures with big payoffs. If communication breaks down, Architects may judge their Explorer colleagues as shortsighted or trigger-happy. Meanwhile, Explorers may dismiss Architects as impractical or uptight. If they don't collaborate, Architects can miss out on exciting opportunities, and Explorers may lose sight of the big picture.

Rebalancing Architect-Explorer Cooperation

Respecting Distinct Types of Genius

Often, Explorers can bring ideas to life in ways Architects would never have thought possible. Genius comes in many forms, and Explorers' genius relies on adaptation and execution. Architects' focus on details may seem tedious to Explorers – not because Explorers want to blatantly ignore Architects, but because it doesn't occur to them to behave in such an exact manner.

For Explorers, "good enough" meets the requirements, and for Architects to get along with their Explorer colleagues, they should try to work with them in a comfortable way. Explorers need a "don't see, don't tell" approach: they'll do it their way. So long as the results are close enough, Architects need to accept the results as good enough.

Despite their differences, Architects and Explorers can achieve success in the workplace. Balancing their very different styles begins with mutual understanding of the strengths and weaknesses that each brings to the table. Architects are notorious for explaining their ideas in abstract ways. However, Explorers are likely to become bored with conceptual matters. Instead of theoretical diatribes, Architects can try the following approach:

- Focus on sharing a quick overview of your idea, complete with the intro and the conclusion but skipping most of the body.

- Take a step back from your Explorer colleagues and respect the need for space.
- Check in with your Explorer colleagues from time to time and make sure to re-iterate the objective the project.

Although Architects are often brilliant problem-solvers as well, they may become paralyzed if they get mired in details. Because many Explorers thrive under pressure, Architects benefit from having such teammates, to whom they can turn when circumstances overwhelm their abilities. Both Architects and Explorers are focused on efficiency, with the former addressing the "why" and the latter addressing the "how." Both can benefit from the other's strengths when addressing a problematic situation, becoming helpful allies once they understand the useful qualities each one brings to the table.

Allowing Communication

In unbalanced working relationships with Explorers, Architects may choose to block out Explorers instead of openly addressing differences of opinion. But stonewalling comes at a cost because it often curtails any chance of collaboration.

To revive communication, Architects might consider how much more effective it is to collaborate rather than work around another individual. In practice, this means soliciting Explorers' opinions and acknowledging their contributions and strengths, as well as complimenting Explorers' mastery of skill. It also entails expressing genuine curiosity about Explorers. The following steps may help:

- Reopen communication by asking Explorers for their input and acknowledging their work.
- Focus on listening, learning, and asking questions rather than debating or being right.
- Express curiosity about what Explorers are doing, asking open-ended questions.

Resourceful and tenacious, Explorers care about getting things done and moving projects forward. If they practice respectful communication, Architects will come to respect and admire the proactive, fearless spirits that their Explorer colleagues bring to the workplace.

Conclusion

Designing the Future

Architects bring innovation, steadfast energy, and necessary efficiency to their positions, qualities that can easily help build an organization up. People with this personality type are likely to be on the cutting edge of experimentation, imagining ways to make the workplace the most effective version of itself. The key for Architects is allowing themselves to appear warmer at work, as well as learning how to customize their approach to different individuals.

Fortunately, Architects possess the ability to improve upon all things, especially themselves. They are the ones to turn to when ideas need to be catapulted or reinforced. They create success for themselves through dedication and efficiency-based idealism, and they have the capacity to carry their ideals throughout their entire career.

Most of all, Architects refuse to let go of the vision they have for themselves, seeking opportunities to work where they feel intellectually stimulated and effective. With work and determination, they can find a place to plant the seed of their professional vision, then feed it and make it grow. In the end, Architects have all the tools they need for success.

Final Words

The Road to Success

At times in their lives, Architects might feel starkly different from other people. In contrast with their values of independence, authenticity, and rationality, most other individuals may seem obsessed with superficiality, materialism, or social norms. Although their uniqueness is empowering, it can also be lonely.

As much as Architects may be tempted to go it alone, most find that interaction and collaboration with others enrich their academic and professional lives. As a result, they do well to seek out kindred spirits, looking for people whose interests and values are suited to the deep conversations that they crave. As they grow, Architects can also develop a genuine appreciation for those who are radically different from them. Everyone in this world has something to contribute, and for them, recognizing other people's unique capacities is a telltale sign of their open minds.

Making Lifelong Progress

In this e-book, we've offered guidance and insights to help Architects get the most out of their education and work, and we'd like to impart a final thought regarding the path forward. Architects crave a deeper level of understanding about the world around them, especially in areas that matter to them personally. Sometimes it's because they need that understanding to make progress in life, and sometimes it's because they wish to engage in a personal passion. When Architects learn as a precursor to doing something, they must decide at which point they feel that they know enough to move forward into action. What qualifies as "enough knowledge to proceed" is specific to the individual, and it's partly a matter of confidence and assumption, as well as the quality of the information that's been gained.

Once that tipping point has been reached, Architects' attention often shifts away from learning and turns toward applying their knowledge and skills, which is a very satisfying feeling. In a way, it's where the rubber meets the road, and they test themselves, their views, and their abilities in the real world. In some ways, it's a shift from absorption to expression, which is a very healthy thing for a personality type so prone to contemplation. However, a focus on active output can sometimes

obscure opportunities to take in critical information. So the final thought that we'd like to share is the idea that even as Architects wade deep into productive, healthy action, they can always remain receptive to learning.

Acting on one's knowledge can be a heady, absorbing, wonderful thing, but Architects are at their best when they're always willing to evolve, welcoming and incorporating new information as they proceed through life. For people with this personality type, the greatest achievements don't necessarily come from knowing "enough" to act successfully, but from an attitude of continual learning that expands how grand their successes can be.

So... What's Next?

You've reached the end of this book, but fear not – we've created many more resources for you. Here are a few that might capture your interest:

- Want to kick-start your career or get better at navigating it? Explore our Career Specialized Tests.
- Looking to set a foundation for learning and developing as a person? Check out the *Architect Guide to Personal Growth*.
- Feeling adrift when it comes to your romantic relationships, friendships, or relationships with your children? Our *Architect Guide to Relationships* may be just what you need.

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